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React JS Lesson 11 – useRef Hook (Premium Notes)

1) What is useRef

- useRef is a React Hook used to store mutable values.
- It can also directly access DOM elements.

Example:

```
const inputRef = useRef();
```

Explanation:

- inputRef stores reference object.

2) useRef syntax

- useRef returns an object with current property.

Example:

```
const myRef = useRef(null);
```

Explanation:

- current stores actual value or DOM element.

3) useRef vs useState

- useState causes re-render when updated.
- useRef does not cause re-render.

Example:

useState → UI updates

useRef → UI not re-rendered

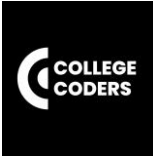
Explanation:

- Choose useRef when UI update not needed.

4) Accessing DOM elements using useRef

- Attach ref to element.

Example:



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```
<input ref={inputRef} />
```

Explanation:

- React connects DOM input to ref object.

5) Auto-focus input using useRef

- Call `focus()` using current.

Example:

```
inputRef.current.focus();
```

Explanation:

- Input becomes active automatically.

6) Storing values without re-render

- `useRef` stores values silently.

Example:

```
countRef.current = countRef.current + 1;
```

Explanation:

- No UI re-render happens.

7) useRef with previous value

- Store previous state manually.

Example:

```
prevRef.current = count;
```

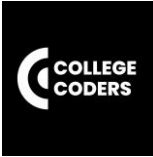
Explanation:

- Useful for comparing old/new values.

8) Mini Project – Focus Input

- Click button and focus input.

Example:



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```
const inputRef = useRef();
```

```
<input ref={inputRef} />
```

```
<button onClick={()=>inputRef.current.focus()}>
```

```
  Focus
```

```
</button>
```

Explanation:

- Button focuses input instantly.

Assignment

- Create focus input project.
- Store previous input value using useRef.
- Compare useRef and useState behavior.